

Douglas World Cruiser



The Douglas World Cruiser (DWC) was specially commissioned by the US Army to attempt the first round-the-world flight. A flight of four aircraft left Seattle on April 6, 1924 and after an epic 175 days (365 hours flying time) covering 27,533 miles (44,298km), DWCs *Chicago* and *New Orleans* returned to Seattle on September 28.

ENGINE 420hp Liberty V 12 water-cooled

WINGSPAN 50ft (15.2m) **LENGTH** 35ft 6in (10.8m)

TOP SPEED 103mph (166kph) **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS None

Fokker F.VII *Southern Cross*

One of the most successful commercial and long-distance aircraft of the 1920s and 30s, the trimotor F.VII was manufactured in Britain, US, Belgium, France, Italy, and Poland, and equipped airlines and air forces worldwide. The F.VIIB-3m was used by pioneers and explorers such as Richard E. Byrd, Amelia Earhart, and, most famously, Charles Kingsford Smith. His *Southern Cross* achieved the first transpacific flight on June 9, 1928, after flying 7,800 miles (12,555km) in 88 hours.

ENGINE 3 x 237hp Wright J-5 Whirlwind 9-cylinder air-cooled radials

WINGSPAN 71ft 3in (21.7m) **LENGTH** 47ft 7in (14.5m)

TOP SPEED 115mph (185kph) **CREW** 2

PASSENGERS 8-10



Lockheed Model 5B Vega

Designed by John Northrop, the first Vega appeared in 1927 and was an immediate success for the young Lockheed Aircraft Company. A family of fast, small airliners and long-distance racers evolved, with 128 being sold by the mid-1930s. One of the most popular versions was the six-seat Vega 5B. In July 1933, the remarkable one-eyed Wiley Post flew his Vega 5C "Winnie Mae" in the first solo around-the-world flight. A Vega was also used by Amelia Earhart when she made her transatlantic solo flight in 1932.

ENGINE 450hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp C1 9-cylinder air-cooled radial

WINGSPAN 41ft (12.5m) **LENGTH** 27ft 6in (8.4m)

TOP SPEED 180mph (290kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS 6 (on commercial aircraft)



Ryan NYP *Spirit of St. Louis*

In February 1927, Claude Ryan received an order for a special version of his monoplane, in which a young mail pilot, with the backing of a group of St. Louis businessmen, aimed to win a \$25,000 prize for the first nonstop flight between New York and Paris. The modifications included moving the cockpit back to allow the installation of a huge fuel tank and increasing the wingspan. The pilot's name was Charles Lindbergh, who reached Paris on May 21, 1927, after 33.5 hours flying.



ENGINE 223hp Wright J-5 Whirlwind 9-cylinder air-cooled radial

WINGSPAN 46ft (14m) **LENGTH** 27ft 7in (8.4m)

AVE SPEED 108mph (173kph) **CREW** 1

PASSENGERS None

R 34



The R 34 was almost an exact copy of the Zeppelin L 33 which had been brought down in September 1916. On July 2, 1919, it left East Fortune airfield near Edinburgh and reached New York 108 hours later, achieving the first East-West crossing against the prevailing winds. When it returned six days later in 75 hours, it completed the first ever double crossing.

ENGINE 5 x 240hp Sunbeam Maori 4

LENGTH 643ft (196m) **DIAMETER** 76ft (23.2m)

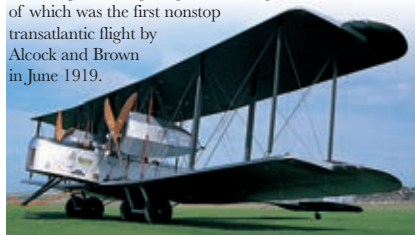
CAPACITY 1,950,000 cubic feet (55,224 cubic metres)

SPEED 55mph (89kph) **CREW** 30

PASSENGERS None

Vickers Vimy F.B.27

Designed as a long-range heavy bomber, the Vimy arrived too late for WWI. However, it achieved some renown pioneering long-distance flights, the most famous of which was the first nonstop transatlantic flight by Alcock and Brown in June 1919.



ENGINE 2 x 360hp Rolls-Royce Eagle VIII

WINGSPAN 68ft (20.7m) **LENGTH** 43ft 7in (13.3m)

TOP SPEED 103mph (166kph) **CREW** 2

ARMAMENT Provision for 2 machine guns

LZ 127 *Graf Zeppelin*

The inventor of the rigid airship. Count von Zeppelin, was almost 62 when his LZ 1 first flew on July 2, 1900. When LZ 127 appeared in 1928, the new liner of the air was called *Graf Zeppelin* in his memory. For almost a decade, this giant carried passengers and cargo, crossing the Atlantic many times and, in 1929, flying around the world at an average speed of 70mph (113kph). A million miles in perfect safety. This all ended with the horrific loss of the even larger *Hindenburg* in May 1937.

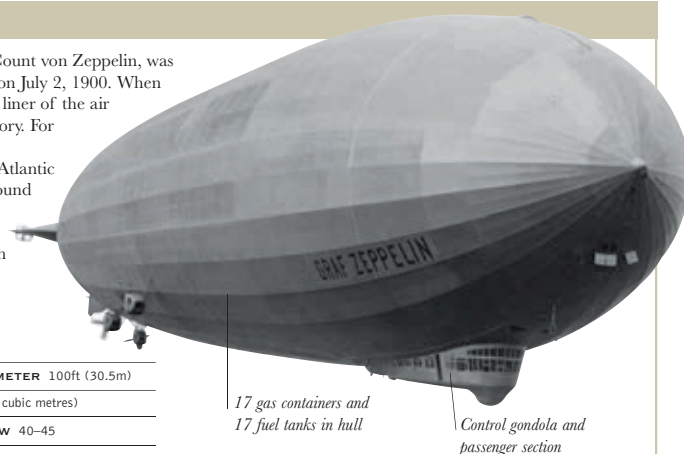
ENGINE 5 x 550hp Maybach VL II V12

LENGTH 776ft 3in (236.6m) **DIAMETER** 100ft (30.5m)

CAPACITY 3,708,040 cubic feet (105,000 cubic metres)

SPEED 72mph (115kph) **CREW** 40-45

PASSENGERS 20



17 gas containers and
17 fuel tanks in hull

Control gondola and
passenger section